CHALLENGE STATEMENT

Trusted Information for Local & Multilingual Communities

BACKGROUND

Communities rely on digital information to stay safe, informed, and connected.

In Singapore, information spreads rapidly through:
- Messaging apps (e.g. WhatsApp, Telegram)
- Forums (e.g. Hardware forum)
- Social media platforms
- Community groups (e.g. Mothership)

During uncertain situations such as health scares, public safety incidents, or policy changes misinformation can spread faster than verified facts.

Misinformation can:
- Cause panic or confusion
- Lead to unsafe decisions
- Undermine trust in institutions and communities

Language barriers and varying digital literacy levels make it harder for people to assess credibility and context.

THE CHALLENGE

When information spreads quickly, people must make trust decisions with limited context.
Today:
- Credibility signals are fragmented
- Source authority is not always obvious
- Claims may circulate without evidence
- Content may be reshared across platforms without verification

Simply deleting or blocking content does not solve the problem. Communities need tools that help people understand information better, not just remove it.
There is an opportunity to use AI to highlight credibility signals, explain the context behind claims, and help people make informed decisions especially in multilingual local communities.

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WHAT SUCCESS LOOKS LIKE

A strong solution could:

1. Clearly Assess Credibility
   - Classify content as:
     - Likely accurate
     - Unverified / uncertain
     - Potentially misleading
   - Explain clearly why the content is classified that way
   - Make uncertainty visible instead of hiding it
2. Surface Useful Context
   - Highlight source credibility signals
   - Show strength (or lack) of supporting evidence
   - Point out missing context
   - Display confidence levels
   - Link to relevant official or verified resources
3. Work Across Languages & Local Context
   - Translate or summarise across local languages
   - Detect cultural references or slang
   - Handle mixed-language content
   - Make information easier to understand for different literacy levels
4. Reduce Real-World Harm
   - Reduce panic during crises
   - Improve clarity during policy changes
   - Strengthen trust in verified information
   - Support healthy community discussion without over-censorship